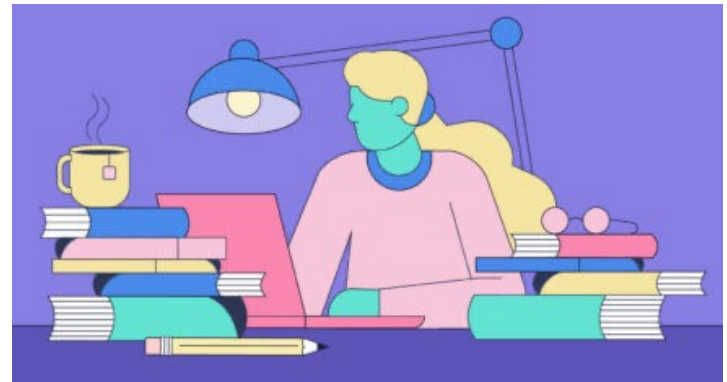


PART 2: HOW TO WRITE A CSS
RESEARCH PAPER (IN 2 ~~WEEKS~~ DAYS)



WRITING PAPERS USING CSS METHODS

This course is not just about CSS methods, but centrally about how to *do research* using these methods.

We have emphasized research papers is *storytelling*.

What I want to see is not necessarily the fanciest method: it's about making waterproof stories that rigorously contribute something - however small - to our knowledge about the world. And how you interpret and situate your methods and your data!

DO'S AND DON'TS OF WRITING A RESEARCH PAPER

Do tell a story

- Writing a paper is storytelling!
- Needs to be something surprising; something interesting.
- Your job is also to be a bit of a journalist. Tell a story!
- "Hourglass" structure: Start broadly, narrow down to specific research questions or hypotheses, then broaden out again to discuss the implications of your findings.

Schimmel. "Writing Science: How to Write Papers That Get Cited and Proposals That Get Funded"



Do use theory

- Use theory to *tell your story*.
- Theory is our tool, and our language
- Focus on using theory to engage with a topical and broadly interesting discussion.

Do work with middle-range theory

- We contribute not to grand theories, nor on the smallest theory, but on the middle-range
- Don't: "I'm going to test whether Goffman's theory of self-presentation is true"
- Do: "How do content recommendation algorithms on YouTube contribute to the formation of echo chambers?"

Do look at examples of similar papers

- Look at other papers doing something similar
- See how they structure their story
- Draw inspiration! (But don't plagiarize)

Do put yourself in the shoes of your audience

- Assume the role of the editor / the peer-reviewer (or in this case me!)
- What are they reading for? What would they complain about?
- What weaknesses would they point to?
- Your peer-reviewer/editor/professor will be tired after already reading dozens of papers the same day: make their life easy and they will like you!

Do speak to your strengths

- The aim here is to produce a good paper – so don't do something that will be unnecessarily hard and unrewarding. (Like scraping data instead of downloading a finished dataset.)
- Draw on your strengths and what you know!
- Do something interesting with limited time and resources!

Do (roughly) follow the structure of a paper

Papers tell their story according to a specific structure:

1. Introduction
2. Background
3. Methods
4. Results
5. Discussion
6. (Conclusion)

Do be nice and respectful to reviewers / authors

Reviewers are using their time to help you.

It's unpaid. They're stressed.

Be nice to them and respect their time.

Don't be too ambitious

Papers are often really small: they nail down a small but broadly important claim
They are 'waterproof': hard to criticize, which means they tend to *do one thing, but well*.
Don't make "perfect" the enemy of good
("the perfect research paper isn't finished yet")





COURSE REVIEW

THE AIMS OF THIS COURSE

- Giving an overview of and demystifying CSS methods
- A practical hands-on introduction to a range of methods
- How to write a paper using a CSS approach
- Independently go in-depth with a chosen method

WHAT HAVE WE COVERED IN THIS COURSE?

1. What is Computational Social Science: Computational paradigm of social science research
2. How to write a research paper: Research as storytelling
3. Programming in Python
4. Web scraping and APIs
5. Ethics & Law of digital data and methods
6. Natural Language Processing
7. Large Language Models
8. Social Network Analysis
9. Machine Learning
10. Agent-based Modeling
11. Online experiments

WHAT YOU COULD EXPECT OF THIS COURSE

- Freedom to pursue your own interest and focus on what you want
- You will learn powerful and useful digital research methods
- A challenging but exciting course

MY EXPECTATIONS OF YOU

- That you work independently responsibility for your learning.
- That you do your own researches you need for your project.
- That you are
- That you show up
- That you show up: attendance is mandatory (you can miss a maximum of 2/12.)
- That you show up on time! (If you miss the attendance sheet, you miss the class.)

Thank you!

You've been great! 😊

COURSE EVALUATION

Before we end, please do the course evaluation!

You should have received a UvA Q survey on your email.